

Bull Run Ends the "Ninety-Day War"

President Abraham Lincoln decided to attack a small Confederate force at **Bull Run**. If successful, the victory would show the superiority of Union arms and might eventually lead to the capture of **Richmond**. On **July 21, 1861**, the Union and Confederate forces met. Unexpectedly, the Confederates won as "Stonewall" Jackson held his line of Confederate soldiers until reinforcements arrived. The loss for the Union dispelled the illusion of a quick end to the war.

"Tardy George" McClellan and the Peninsular Campaign

In **1861**, General George B. McClellan was given command of the Army of the Potomac.

Starting the **Peninsula Campaign**, McClellan's army launched a waterborne attack in the spring of **1862** that moved towards **Richmond**. He came to within sight of **Richmond** and attacked "Stonewall" Jackson. General Robert E. Lee launched a counterattack against the Union forces, known as the **Seven Days' Battles**, from June 26 to July 2, 1862 and drove McClellan's forces back to the sea.

The Northern military plan had **6 components**:

- 1) Slowly suffocate the South by blockading its coasts.
- 2) Liberate the slaves and undermine the economic foundation of the South.
- 3) Cut the Confederacy in half by seizing control of the Mississippi River.
- 4) Dismember the Confederacy by sending troops through Georgia and the Carolinas.
- 5) Capture its capital at Richmond.
- 6) Try everywhere to engage the enemy and grind it into submission.

The War at Sea

The Northern sea **blockades** were concentrated at the South's main ports.

To overcome the strong blockades, fast ships were developed to run through them. These ships made a lot of profit by exchanging cargoes of arms for **cotton**.

In **1862**, the Confederates created the **Merrimack** and renamed it the **Virginia**. It was an old U.S. wooden ship that was plated with metal armor. It threatened the Northern blockades because it could crush through the Union's wooden ships.

On **March 9, 1862**, the Union ironclad, the **Monitor**, and the Confederate **Merrimack** met and fought to a standstill.

The Pivotal Point: Antietam

After General Lee crushed McClellan's forces in Richmond, Lee moved northward. In the **Second Battle of Bull Run** (August 29-30, 1862), General Lee defeated General Pope's Union forces.

As Lee moved into Maryland, he met McClellan's forces again at the **Battle of Antietam** on September 17, 1862. McClellan managed to halt Lee's forces after his forces discovered Lee's battle plans.

Although not a victory, the Union stopped the Confederate march northward.

Antietam provided Lincoln with the military backing to issue the preliminary **Emancipation Proclamation** on September 23, 1862. On January 1, 1863, Lincoln issued a final proclamation. Lincoln now made the Civil War a war to end slavery.

A Proclamation without Emancipation

The Emancipation Proclamation called for the freeing of all slaves in Confederate territory, except in locations where the Union had mostly regained control. Lincoln did not require slaves to be freed in the Border States because he feared that they would secede. The proclamation fundamentally changed the

nature of the war because it effectively removed any chance of a negotiated settlement between the North and the South.

The **13th Amendment** to the Constitution was passed in 1865, 8 months after the Civil War ended. This legally ended slavery.

Editor's Note: Wikipedia has a great map that shows the [regions covered by the Proclamation](#) (right side of page).

With the Emancipation Proclamation, many people in the South said that Lincoln was just trying to stir up slave rebellion.

The North now had a much **stronger moral cause**. It had to preserve the Union and free the slaves.

Blacks Battle Bondage

After the Emancipation Proclamation and as manpower ran low, blacks were allowed to enlist in the Union army. Towards the end of the war, the Confederacy allowed blacks to enlist, but by then it was too late.

Lee's Last Lunge at Gettysburg

After Antietam, Lincoln replaced McClellan as commander of the Army of the Potomac with General A. E. Burnside. Due to Burnside's massive defeat at **Fredericksburg, Virginia** on December 13, 1862, he was replaced by Hooker. During the battle at **Chancellorsville, Virginia** on May 2-4, 1863, Hooker was badly beaten, but not before Jackson was mortally wounded. Hooker was replaced by General George G. Meade.

As Lee moved his Confederate force to the north again (this time to Pennsylvania), he was met by Meade's force at **Gettysburg** on July 1-3, 1863. The failure of General George **Pickett's charge** enabled the Union to win the battle. Confederate President Jefferson Davis was planning to deliver **negotiators** to Washington D.C. after Confederates won at Gettysburg. Since the Union ended up winning the battle, Lincoln did not negotiate with the South.

At a cemetery dedication in Gettysburg, Lincoln delivered the **Gettysburg Address**.

The War in the West

Ulysses S. Grant became a colonel in the **Union volunteer army**. His first victory was when he captured **Fort Henry and Fort Donelson** in February 1862. He next planned to capture a line of railroads in the Mississippi Valley in Corinth. His plan was foiled when he was defeated by a Confederate force at the **Battle of Shiloh** on April 6-7, 1862.

General Grant was given command of the Union forces attacking **Vicksburg**. The city fell and surrendered on July 4, 1863.

Due to **back-to-back** Union military **victories** at the Battle of Gettysburg and the Battle of Vicksburg, all Confederate hopes for foreign help were lost.

Sherman Scorches Georgia

General Grant won the battle at **Chattanooga**, and the state of **Tennessee** was cleared of Confederates. Grant was made general in chief due to this win.

General William Tecumseh Sherman led the invasion of **Georgia**. He captured **Atlanta** in September of 1864 and burned it in November. He destroyed rail lines and burned buildings. **Sherman's March** continued on through Georgia, intent on destroying supplies destined for the Confederate army. By waging war on their homes, Sherman also sought to reduce the morale of the men at the front. Sherman captured **Savannah** on December 22, 1864. He moved up through **South Carolina**, capturing and burning **Columbia** on February 17, 1865.

The Politics of War

Critics in President Lincoln's own party were led by secretary of the Treasury, Salmon Chase.

The **Congressional Committee on the Conduct of the War**, formed in late **1861**, was dominated by radical Republicans who resented emancipation and the expansion of presidential power in wartime.

After Stephen A. Douglas, the leader of the Democratic Party in the North, died, the party split between those who supported Lincoln (**War Democrats**) and those who didn't (**Peace Democrats**).

Congressman Clement L. Vallandigham was a prominent member in a group called the **Copperheads**, which were radical Peace Democrats. Vallandigham was banished from the North to the South by Lincoln but he later returned after the war had ended.

The Election of 1864

Fearing defeat, the Republicans joined with the War Democrats to form the **Union Party** in the **election of 1864**. Lincoln's running-mate was Andrew Johnson, a local War Democrat.

The Democrats, including the Copperheads, nominated General McClellan as their presidential candidate.

The Northern Democrats lost the election of 1864. This was a big defeat for the South; the removal of Lincoln was the last hope for a Confederate victory.

Grant Outlasts Lee

President Lincoln chose General Grant to lead the assault on the Confederate capital of **Richmond**.

Grant had 100,000 men and engaged Lee in a series of battles in the Wilderness of Virginia (**Wilderness Campaign**).

On June 3, 1864, Grant ordered the frontal assault on **Cold Harbor**. Thousands of Union soldiers were killed within a matter of minutes, but Grant's strategy of losing two Union men to one Confederate man worked. He captured Richmond and cornered Lee. On **April 9, 1865**, Lee was forced to surrender the Army of Northern Virginia (a significant portion of the Confederate army) at **Appomattox Courthouse** in Virginia, effectively ending the Civil War.

The Martyrdom of Lincoln

On **April 14, 1865**, President Lincoln was shot and killed at **Ford's Theater** by southerner, John Wilkes Booth. Andrew Johnson took over as President.

The Aftermath of the Nightmare

The Civil War claimed over 600,000 lives and cost over \$15 billion (year 2001 dollars).

Britain extended the right to vote to more of its people with the **Reform Bill of 1867**. American democracy had proven itself and the disfranchised British people used this to justify their own democracy.